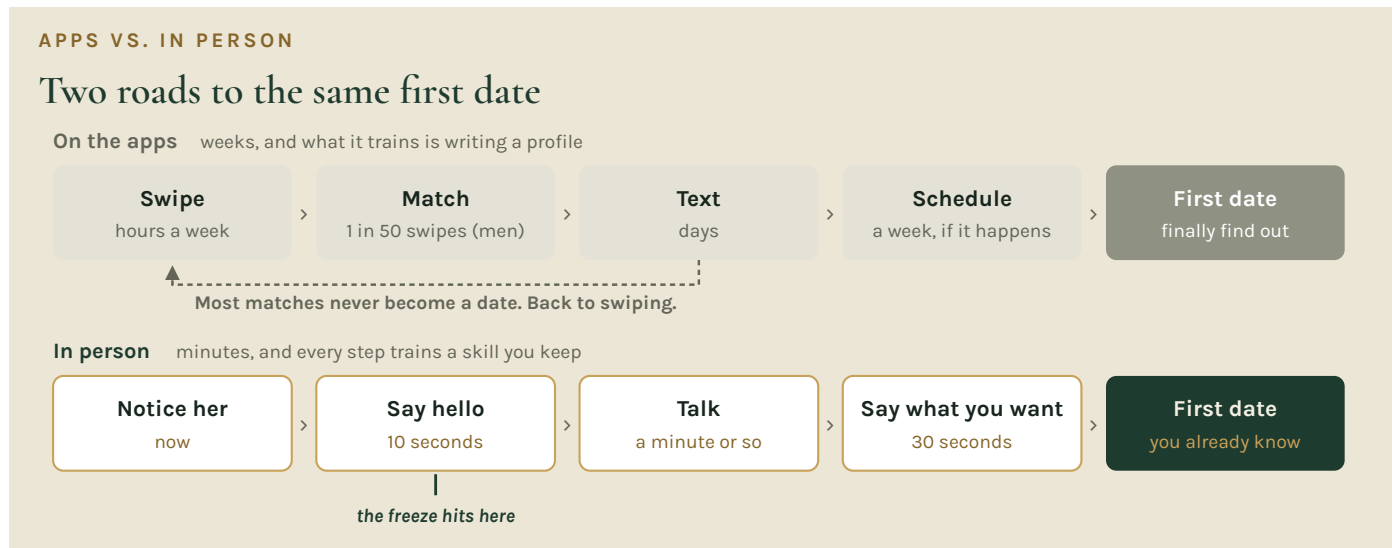


Fuck Dating Apps.

The field note: what to do instead.

You know why the apps keep you swiping. This is what to do instead, starting this week: read the room, say an honest hello, and build up to it one small rep at a time.



Before you say a word

Wanting to talk to her isn't creepy. Hiding your interest, or ignoring her signals, is. So be honest about why you're there, and read the room first.

What you see	What it means	What you do
Headphones in, turned away, buried in her phone	Busy. Not a no to you, a no to everyone.	Leave her be.
Mid-conversation, in a hurry, at work	Not now. If she's working, she can't walk away from you.	Chat if it's natural. Don't pursue.
Short answers, no eye contact after your hello	She's said no.	Say a friendly goodbye. Mean it. Leave her alone.
Eyes up, open to the room, lingering, looks back twice	Green light.	Say hello. Start a conversation.
You honestly can't tell	Unclear.	One short hello. How she responds is your answer.

The first two minutes

- **Say hello, with the truth.** "Hi, I noticed you and wanted to say hi. I'm [your name]." That's the whole opener.
- **Ask one real question.** About right now: the book, the dog, the thing she's carrying, what she's up to today. Curiosity, not a line.
- **Listen.** Reply to what she actually said, not to what you planned to say next.
 - Notice your level of attraction: how excited are you to continue the conversation with her?
 - Notice her body language: does she turn toward you, hold eye contact, ask you something back?
- **Say what you want.** If it's going well: "I'd like to continue this conversation another time. Can I get your number?"
- **If she turns you down, accept the "no" gracefully.** "No worries, have a nice day." Then actually leave.
- **If she says yes, make a clean exit.** "Great, I'll text you." Then go.

The ladder: one step at a time

If you don't feel comfortable jumping straight to the full approach outlined above, start small. Stay on a rung until your body is bored there, then climb. Bored means trained. Start this week with three Rung 1 reps.

- **Rung 1.** Ten seconds with a stranger, no goal. Ask for a recommendation, comment on the queue, hold the door and say something polite.
- **Rung 2.** A genuine compliment to a stranger, about something she chose. The jacket, the book, the bike. Not her body. Leave without asking for anything.
- **Rung 3.** Start a conversation with a woman you're not attracted to. A colleague, a neighbor, the person who makes your coffee. As simple as, "How's your day going?"
- **Rung 4.** Say hello to someone you're attracted to and talk. No ask. Leave when it winds down.
- **Rung 5.** The full approach above, ask included.

The freeze, and what to do with it

The freeze before you say hi is not a character flaw. It means you care.

But that same instinct gets in the way of connection. It's the mark of an untrained nervous system. The freeze lives in your body - not your head. So just like learning a physical skill, overcoming it requires training the body.

Before an approach: Take a long, slow breath, then exhale longer than you inhaled. Remind your body that it's safe. Then go, while your body is settled.

After a no: Nothing to fix. Log it below. A no is information - not a personal judgment about you.

After a yes: Nice. Log it. Notice what your body did.

Exercise log

Print this or copy it into your notes. Five a week is plenty. Rate your comfort from 1 (frozen) to 5 (easy). Three 4s or 5s in a row on a rung means you're ready for the next one. After your first five, book a free call and bring your log. We'll go through it together.

Day	Rung	What I said	What happened	Comfort (1-5)

Ready to actually meet someone?

I go deeper in a free 45-minute live session: why the freeze happens and how to train it. Or book a free discovery call and we'll start with your log. Let's bring back in-person dating.

Free live session

marcuslevine.com/webinar

Free discovery call

cal.com/marcuslevine/discovery